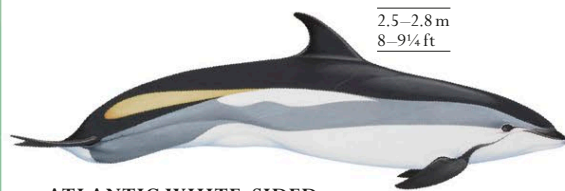


OCEANIC DOLPHINS

Found worldwide, often in shallow seas over continental shelves, the Delphinidae typically have a curved dorsal fin, protruding beak, and swollen forehead. Small- to medium-sized, their colours and patterns vary widely. Most mainly eat fish and travel in herds or "pods". Larger species are collectively known as blackfish.



ATLANTIC WHITE-SIDED DOLPHIN
Lagenorhynchus acutus

Restricted to cool North Atlantic waters, this dolphin has well-defined black, grey, and white markings, with a yellow flank stripe.

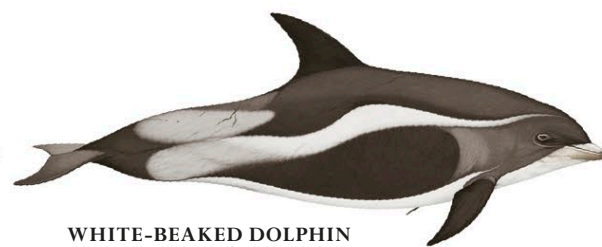
2.5–2.8 m
8–9¼ ft



HOURLASS DOLPHIN
Lagenorhynchus cruciger

Rarely seen, this sub-Antarctic dolphin has two white flank lobes. It frequently associates with fin whales, and was valued by whalers, who used the dolphins to locate the whales.

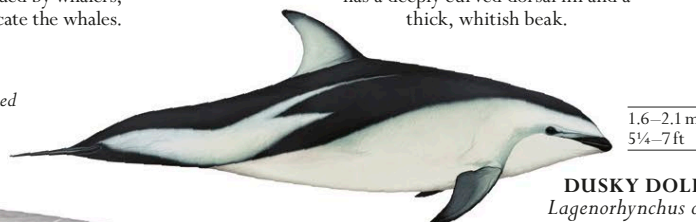
1.6–1.9 m
5¼–6¼ ft



WHITE-BEAKED DOLPHIN
Lagenorhynchus albirostris

Highly acrobatic, this North Atlantic species frequently rides the bow wave of boats. It has a deeply curved dorsal fin and a thick, whitish beak.

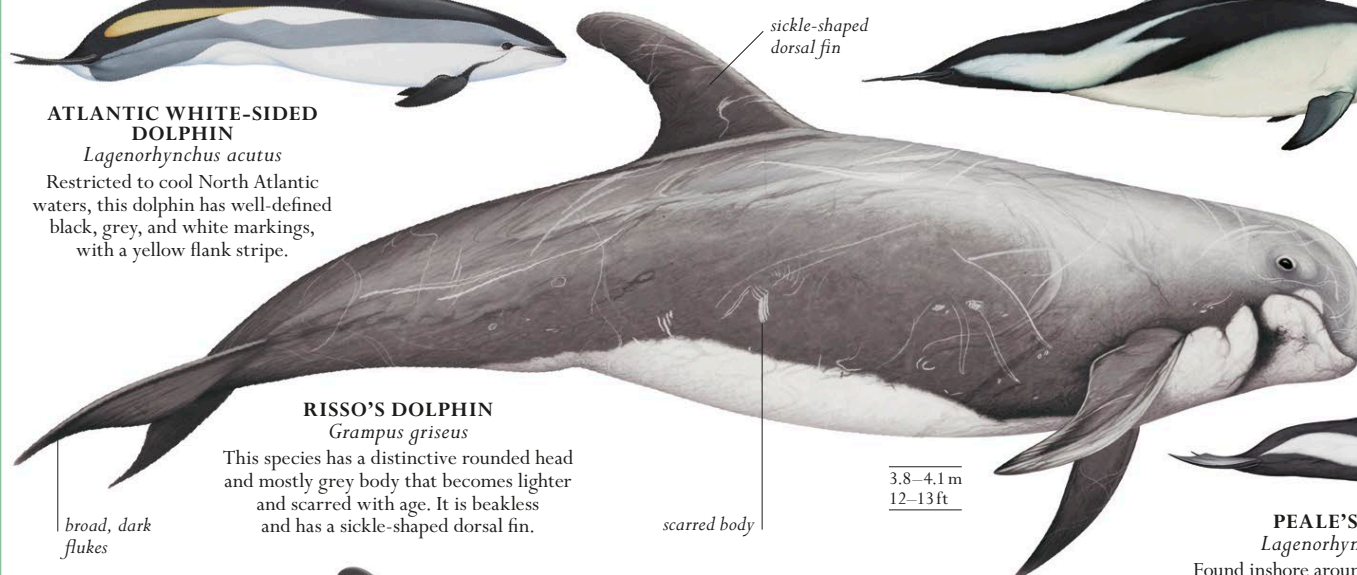
2.4–3.1 m
7¾–10 ft



DUSKY DOLPHIN
Lagenorhynchus obscurus

Widely distributed in coastal waters across the southern hemisphere, this is a gregarious and highly acrobatic dolphin, frequently leaping as it feeds.

1.6–2.1 m
5¼–7 ft



RISSE'S DOLPHIN
Grampus griseus

This species has a distinctive rounded head and mostly grey body that becomes lighter and scarred with age. It is beakless and has a sickle-shaped dorsal fin.

broad, dark flukes

scarred body

3.8–4.1 m
12–13 ft



PEALE'S DOLPHIN
Lagenorhynchus australis

Found inshore around southern S. America, this dolphin shares its white "armpit" patch with *Cephalorhynchus* species, and may be closely related to that genus.

2–2.2 m
6½–7¼ ft



1.5 m
5 ft

COMMERSON'S DOLPHIN
Cephalorhynchus commersonii

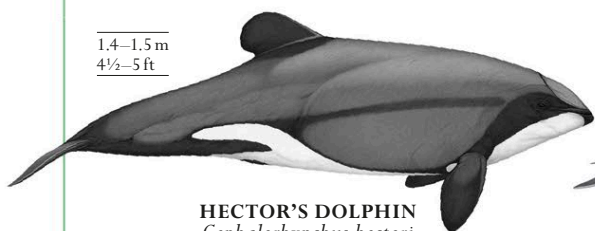
A small, piebald, beakless dolphin from the waters around southern S. America and the Indian Ocean, this excellent swimmer and jumper has broad, blunt tail flukes.



FRASER'S DOLPHIN
Lagenodelphis hosei

This highly gregarious species is found in deep water in the southern hemisphere. Its flippers, fin, and beak are small in proportion to its stocky body.

2.4–2.7 m
7¾–8¾ ft



1.4–1.5 m
4½–5 ft

HECTOR'S DOLPHIN
Cephalorhynchus hectori

Found only in New Zealand waters, Hector's dolphin is the smallest member of its family. It has a rounded dorsal fin with an undercut rear margin.



TUCUXI
Sotalia fluviatilis

Although inhabiting rivers in the Amazon basin, the tucuxi is related to oceanic species, not true river dolphins. It resembles a small bottlenose dolphin.

1.5 m
5 ft



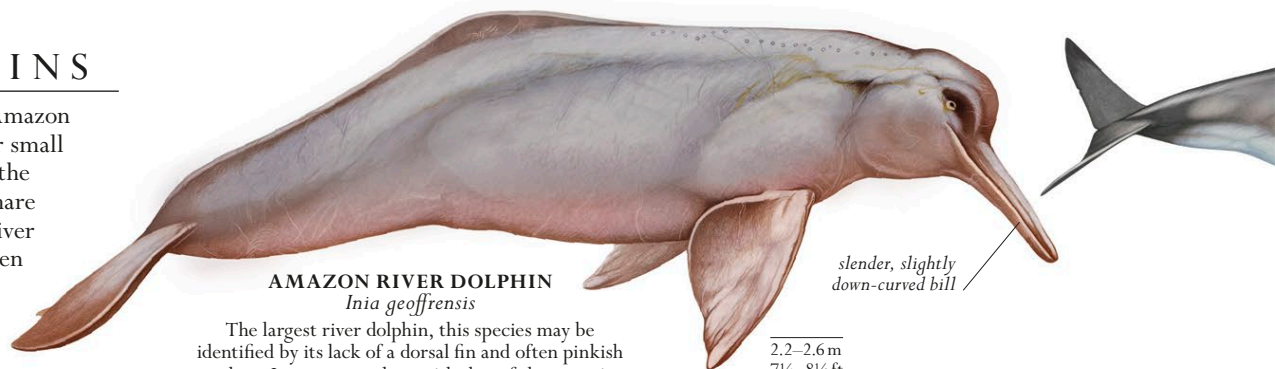
SHORT-BEAKED COMMON DOLPHIN
Delphinus delphis

Often forming large groups, this dolphin has a characteristic hourglass flank pattern, which can be easily seen when it leaps out of the water.

1.6–2.3 m
5¼–7½ ft

RIVER AND ESTUARINE DOLPHINS

The family Iniidae comprises three species of Amazon river dolphin, which can be recognized by their small eyes, bulging forehead, and a long beak, as can the Franciscana of the family Pontopriidae. They share their long, slender beak with the South Asian river dolphin, although their teeth are not visible when the mouth is closed.



AMAZON RIVER DOLPHIN
Inia geoffrensis

The largest river dolphin, this species may be identified by its lack of a dorsal fin and often pinkish colour. Its range overlaps with that of the tucuxi.

slender, slightly down-curved bill

2.2–2.6 m
7¼–8½ ft